

JAMS AND JELLIES



Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why is sugar important when making jams and jellies at home?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

It helps the jam or jelly form a gel and preserves it.

FUN FACT

Sugar helps make jam thick and tasty while keeping it safe to eat!

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

JAMS AND JELLIES



Tweens (10–14)

Q

What role does pectin play in making jams and jellies?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

It causes the jam or jelly to gel and thicken.

FUN FACT

Pectin is a natural gel maker found in fruit seeds and skins.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why do some recipes add lemon juice when making jams or jellies?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Lemon juice adds acid which helps the gel form properly.

FUN FACT

A little lemon juice helps jams set up nice and firm!

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

What happens if you reduce sugar in a jam recipe without changing anything else?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

The jam might be runny and not safe to store.

FUN FACT

Sugar helps jams stay thick and safe, so don't just cut it out!

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

How can you make a low-sugar jam that still gels well?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Use special low-sugar pectin designed for less sugar jams.

FUN FACT

Low-sugar pectin helps jams gel without all the sugar!

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



Q

Why shouldn't you double a freezer jam recipe?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

It can cause the jam to be runny and sugar may not dissolve well.

FUN FACT

Making too much freezer jam at once can stop it from setting right!

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



Q

How long should freezer jam stand at room temperature before freezing?

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ANSWER

**Some recipes say 24 hours,
others can be frozen
immediately.**

FUN FACT

*Following the recipe closely helps your
freezer jam turn out just right!*

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



Q

What kind of containers should you use for freezer jam?

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ANSWER

Pint or half-pint glass or rigid plastic containers with tight lids.

FUN FACT

Good containers keep freezer jam fresh and stop freezer burn!

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

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Q

What is a sign that your jam or jelly has reached the gel point during cooking?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

The mixture sheets from a spoon or is 8 degrees above boiling point.

FUN FACT

Testing your jam with a spoon helps you know when it's ready!

Source: EM 9446 Playing it safe when preserving elderberries

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why is it important to process canned jams and jellies in a boiling water canner?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To kill bacteria and seal jars safely for storage.

FUN FACT

Boiling water canners keep your jams safe to eat by stopping germs!

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



Q

What happens if you use too much acid in a jam recipe?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

The gel can weep or become watery.

FUN FACT

Too much lemon juice can make some jams watery instead of thick.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

**Why do jam jars
sometimes need to be
boiled before use?**

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

To sterilize them and kill any germs before filling.

FUN FACT

Hot jars keep your jam safe by stopping bad germs from growing!

Source: EM 9446 Playing it safe when preserving elderberries

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is the best size of jars to use for jam to set properly?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Half-pint or pint jars because they cool quickly and set well.

FUN FACT

Small jars cool fast which helps jams get firm and yummy!

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



Q

What is the headspace for jam when filling jars before sealing?

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ANSWER

About 1/4 inch for jam, to leave room for expansion.

FUN FACT

Leaving a little space on top of the jam helps when jars expand during sealing!

Source: EM 9446 Playing it safe when preserving elderberries



Q

Why do freezer jams need to be stored in the refrigerator after opening?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because they are not cooked and can spoil quickly if left out.

FUN FACT

Freezer jam is yummy and fresh but needs to stay cold to keep safe!

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Q

Why can jam be made from slightly underripe fruit sometimes?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because underripe fruit has more natural pectin to help gel formation.

FUN FACT

Unripe fruit has more natural gel stuff that helps jams set up.

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home



Q

What happens if you don't follow the pectin package instructions when making jam?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

The jam might not gel or could be a runny mess.

FUN FACT

Pectin works best when you follow the recipe exactly!

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

What is one reason to use honey in place of some sugar in jam?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Honey can replace part of the sugar, but the texture might change.

FUN FACT

Honey sweetens jam but can change how it feels and tastes!

Source: SP 50-632 Making berry syrups at home

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Tweens (10–14)

Q

Why is it important to measure fruit and sugar accurately in jam recipes?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

Because the right balance helps gel form and keeps jam safe.

FUN FACT

Measuring carefully helps make perfect jam every time!

Source: EM 9446 Playing it safe when preserving elderberries



Q

What does "gel" mean when talking about jams and jellies?

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Tweens (10–14)

ANSWER

It's the thick, jelly-like texture that holds the fruit spread together.

FUN FACT

Gel is what makes jam spread thick and yummy, not runny!

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